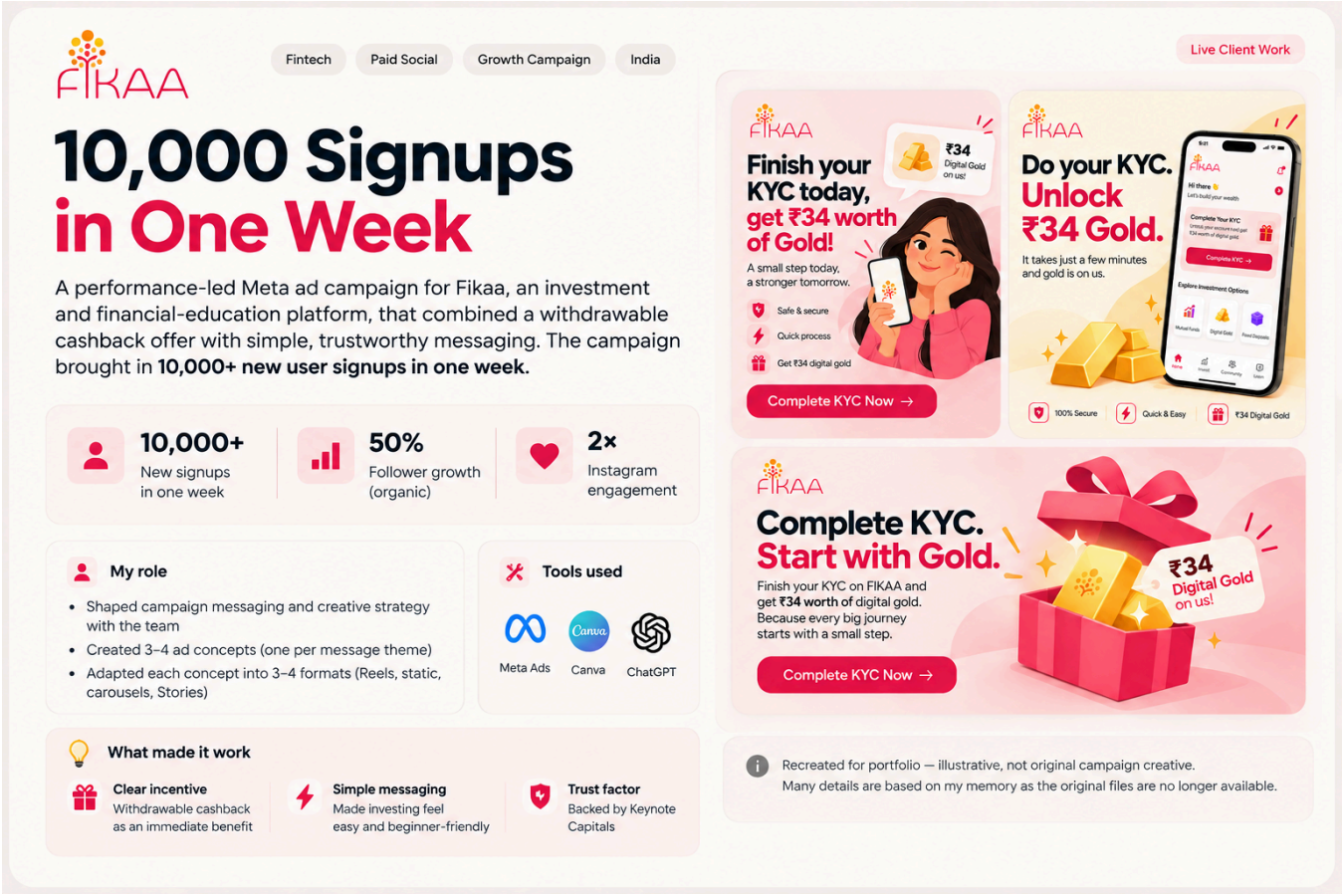
FIKAA: 10,000 Signups and KYC

Nov 12, 2026 · @Richa

Live client work · Fintech · 10,000+ signups in about a week

Everyone loves free gold. That was the problem.

Offer people ₹34 of free digital gold and they will show up. More than 10,000 of them did, in about a week. I'm proud of that number. But I believe the real story is the question underneath it: **how many came for FIKAA, and how many just came for the gold?**



AI-generated for visual representation and better understanding.

Disclosure. This was live client work. I've written it retrospectively, from memory, supported by public research and AI-assisted drafting and structuring. Some details are approximate. Any recreated or AI-generated visuals are labelled. The original campaign files and complete performance reporting weren't available to me.

Attribution. The 10,000+ signup result is a team outcome I contributed to. I'm not presenting it as an individual result.

At a glance

Detail	
Brand	FIKAA, a women-first investment and financial-education platform
Offer recalled	Complete KYC and receive ₹34 worth of digital gold
Campaign objective	Encourage KYC completion and approval; signups were an earlier funnel step
Reported result	10,000+ signups in approximately one week
My contribution	Creative hooks and copy, message direction, design strategy and format adaptations
My honest assessment	Partially successful: strong reported signup volume; downstream user quality couldn't be quantified

Executive summary

A milestone worth celebrating, with a question worth asking.

FIKAA wanted women to take their first real step into investing. So we gave them a reason to start: complete your KYC, get ₹34 worth of digital gold.

It worked. Over 10,000 people signed up and completed KYC in about a week. For a young fintech brand, that's a number any team would be proud of.

But a signup count can't explain everything. A few things showed up that, honestly, I still think about:

- **Reward seekers.** Some people clearly wanted the gold more than they wanted FIKAA.
- **KYC drop-off.** Asking someone for their personal documents is a big ask, and it's where people hesitated most.
- **Audience drift.** A women-first brand was signing up a noticeable number of men. That's not wrong. But it told me the reward was speaking louder than the brand.

That gap, between the action a campaign can easily get and the behaviour a business actually needs, is what this case study is really about.

My contribution

- Worked with the team on message direction and how the incentive should be framed.
- Developed hooks and copy around the KYC action and the digital-gold offer.
- Contributed to roughly 3–4 creative concepts and, as I recall, 3 formats per concept. These counts are recollections, not verified production records.
- Adapted creative ideas across formats, rather than treating each placement as a separate strategy.
- Raised concerns about reward-seeking users and suggested stronger qualification or reward mechanics.

Business and product context

FIKAA in the 2023 to early-2024 market.

Public coverage from 2023 described FIKAA as a women-focused investment app offering financial education and investment access, including mutual funds and digital gold. In November 2023, FIKAA announced Naina, a virtual brand ambassador, as part of its women-first positioning. That sets the wider brand context. It doesn't independently verify the details of this specific acquisition campaign.

The clearest direct competitor I found was LXME. In June 2023, LXME and DSP Mutual Fund launched GULLUCK, a digital saving tool for women that channelled savings into mutual funds. Its campaign line, "Darling, Savings mein Don't Be Silly", connected a familiar saving habit to smarter financial choices. In September 2023, LXME also introduced a women-centric RuPay Dream Card.

Here's how I see it: the challenge was never just another app download. FIKAA's creative had a double job: sell an immediate offer, and stay connected to its bigger financial-independence purpose.

The business problem

The first step into a financial product is harder than an ad makes it look. An incentive can lower that first barrier. But the business still needs users to understand the platform, complete verification, and decide they actually want to invest. The real challenge was giving people a compelling reason to start, without letting the incentive become the *only* reason to start.

Problem definition

The real conversion challenge was everything after the click.

A ₹34 reward is easy to want. Trusting an app with your PAN and Aadhaar is harder. Deciding to invest your own money is harder still.

Each step asks for more commitment than the one before. I believe the creative's job was to make the first step feel worth it, without making the reward the only reason to take it.

Layer	Problem to solve	What success should show
Attention	Make the offer stand out in a crowded fintech feed	People notice and understand the offer
Initial intent	Give people a reason to start	People register and begin the intended onboarding step
KYC completion	Explain why verification is required and what to do next	Users complete and pass KYC at a measurable rate
Qualified activation	Avoid relying only on the reward as the reason to join	Approved users move towards a first investment or meaningful product action
Brand fit	Support FIKAA's women-first positioning	Audience and message fit the brand purpose, without assuming other groups are automatically low quality

The central tension

The incentive was brilliant for acquisition. But it came with a trade-off: the more the reward looked like a standalone benefit, the more likely we were to attract people who wanted the gold without wanting the product.

What I remember, and what I genuinely don't know

- **Recalled signal:** some users seemed mainly interested in the incentive.
- **Recalled signal:** KYC was a real friction point, because sharing personal information feels sensitive, even intimidating.
- **Recalled signal:** men also signed up and completed KYC, despite FIKAA's women-first positioning.
- **Unknown:** the share of incentive-only users, the exact KYC completion rate, the approved KYC count, cost per approved KYC and first-investment rate.

Audience and persona

A women-first platform, with beginner-friendly messaging.

A strategic hypothesis built from FIKAA's positioning and my recollection, not a targeting report. The people we spoke to were early in their money journey: earning, maybe saving, but not yet confident about investing, and wary of handing over their documents.

Persona: Ananya, 24

A composite. Details are illustrative and every attribute is a hypothesis.

Demographics. Ananya is 24, lives in a shared flat in Pune and grew up in a Tier 2 city. She studied commerce and has worked in marketing for two years, earning around ₹45,000 a month. She's the first woman in her family to manage her own salary. She has a savings account and a small recurring deposit, and pays for almost everything by UPI. She's never completed an investment KYC.

Psychographics. Money still feels like "a dad thing", and she quietly wants to change that. She's ambitious, but scared of looking silly around people who seem to know finance better. She saves finfluencer posts and rarely acts on them. Scam stories make her wary of any app asking for documents. Gold feels familiar, because her mother bought it every Dhanteras; mutual funds feel abstract. She loves a deal, but researches before committing real money.

Behaviour. She finds apps through Reels and friends, downloads fast and abandons fast, often dropping off the moment onboarding asks for something she doesn't have to hand.

What she wants: control of her money, without needing a finance degree. **What stops her:** not knowing where to start, and not trusting an app with her details.

Barriers and how the creative answers them

Barrier	Possible thought	Creative response
Reason to act	"Why should I sign up today?"	Make the ₹34 digital-gold offer clear, and explain the action needed to qualify
Confidence	"I don't know enough about investing."	Plain language and one main idea; never make the person feel uninformed
Trust	"Why should I trust this platform with my details?"	Accurate, verifiable brand and product context, not vague reassurance

Barrier	Possible thought	Creative response
KYC friction	"Why do I need to share this information?"	Explain the verification step clearly and point users to the legitimate onboarding flow
Relevance beyond reward	"What happens after I get the reward?"	Connect the first action to FIKAA's wider financial-independence purpose

Women-first doesn't mean every male signup is low quality

I want to be careful here. Men can absolutely be legitimate users. The concern was that the brand's positioning and the actual response may not have lined up, while the reward appealed to people regardless of their interest in FIKAA's purpose. Audience fit and downstream behaviour are better judges of quality than gender.

Competitive and creative audit

What the category was saying.

A retrospective audit of public positioning and one campaign example from the period. Not a full archive of competitor ads, and no claims about how they performed.

Brand / campaign	Observed message	Creative pattern	Implication for FIKAA
LXME × DSP GULLUCK, June 2023	A digital saving tool for women that connected familiar saving behaviour to mutual funds	Everyday behaviour, approachable language and a relatable cultural insight	A women-first platform can make finance relevant through a human insight, not only an incentive
LXME Dream Card, September 2023	A women-centric RuPay product linked to budgeting, shopping and financial independence	Product-led offering within a broader women-first ecosystem	Women-first positioning was becoming a platform promise, not a single product message

Brand / campaign	Observed message	Creative pattern	Implication for FIKAA
FIKAA public positioning, 2023	Financial independence through knowledge and action; education, mutual funds and digital gold	Education and investment access framed around women's confidence and independence	A short-term acquisition offer should connect to the wider brand purpose
Mainstream investing apps	Convenience, product access and digital onboarding	Simple product claims and low-friction journeys	Ease alone may not set FIKAA apart; audience relevance and trust also matter

What the audit tells me

- **Women-first is a positioning territory, not a creative idea.** The ad still needs a specific human tension, or a real reason to act.
- **Everyday money behaviour makes investing feel relevant.** LXME GULLUCK is a good public example of exactly this.
- **A reward is clear, but easy to copy.** It doesn't explain why anyone should stay with FIKAA.
- **Trust needs proof and a good onboarding experience,** not vague reassurance.
- **Signup volume isn't the whole story.** Measurement has to follow KYC and activation.

Strategic synthesis

Three reasons to take the first step, and two questions a reward can't answer.

Insight	Interpretation	Creative implication
The offer answers "why now?"	A concrete reward reduces hesitation and creates urgency	Lead with ₹34 worth of digital gold and clearly state the required action
Simplicity answers "can I do this?"	People new to investing get put off by jargon or an unclear process	Plain language; make KYC the visible next step, not a hidden detail

Insight	Interpretation	Creative implication
Trust answers "why this platform?"	Financial onboarding asks for sensitive information and needs credibility	Use verifiable company and product context, and explain the process
Brand purpose answers "why beyond the reward?"	FIKAA's women-first, financial-independence positioning gives a bigger reason to engage	Test a purpose-led or education-led angle against the direct reward message
Signup volume doesn't answer "who stays?"	A reward may attract users with little interest in the platform itself	Measure KYC completion, approval and activation alongside acquisition

The strategic decision

If I had to put it on a sticky note: keep the incentive as a clear acquisition hook, but never let it be the only reason to act. A stronger iteration would test whether direct-response, education and women-first financial-confidence messages lead to different levels of KYC completion and meaningful activation.

A retrospective synthesis, not a strategy deck from the original launch.

Campaign platform

Make the first step tangible, then connect it to a bigger reason.

The offer was simple: complete KYC, get ₹34 of digital gold. Rather than invent a historical tagline, I'd anchor the platform in the link between that incentive and FIKAA's women-first purpose.

Platform element	Recommended articulation
Immediate promise	A clear digital-gold reward for completing the required KYC step
Functional reason	The offer gives a concrete reason to start onboarding
Emotional reason	A manageable first step can make financial participation feel approachable
Brand connection	FIKAA's purpose: supporting women's financial independence through knowledge and action

Platform element	Recommended articulation
Primary action	Complete the required KYC; signup alone isn't the final conversion
Guardrail	Make eligibility and reward terms clear; never imply KYC can be skipped or that returns are guaranteed

Messaging hierarchy

- **First: what do I get?** State the reward accurately and visibly.
- **Second: what do I need to do?** Make the KYC action and eligibility clear.
- **Third: why should I trust this?** Use truthful brand and product information, and a transparent process.
- **Fourth: why does this matter beyond the reward?** Connect the entry point to financial learning and independence, without overloading the first frame.

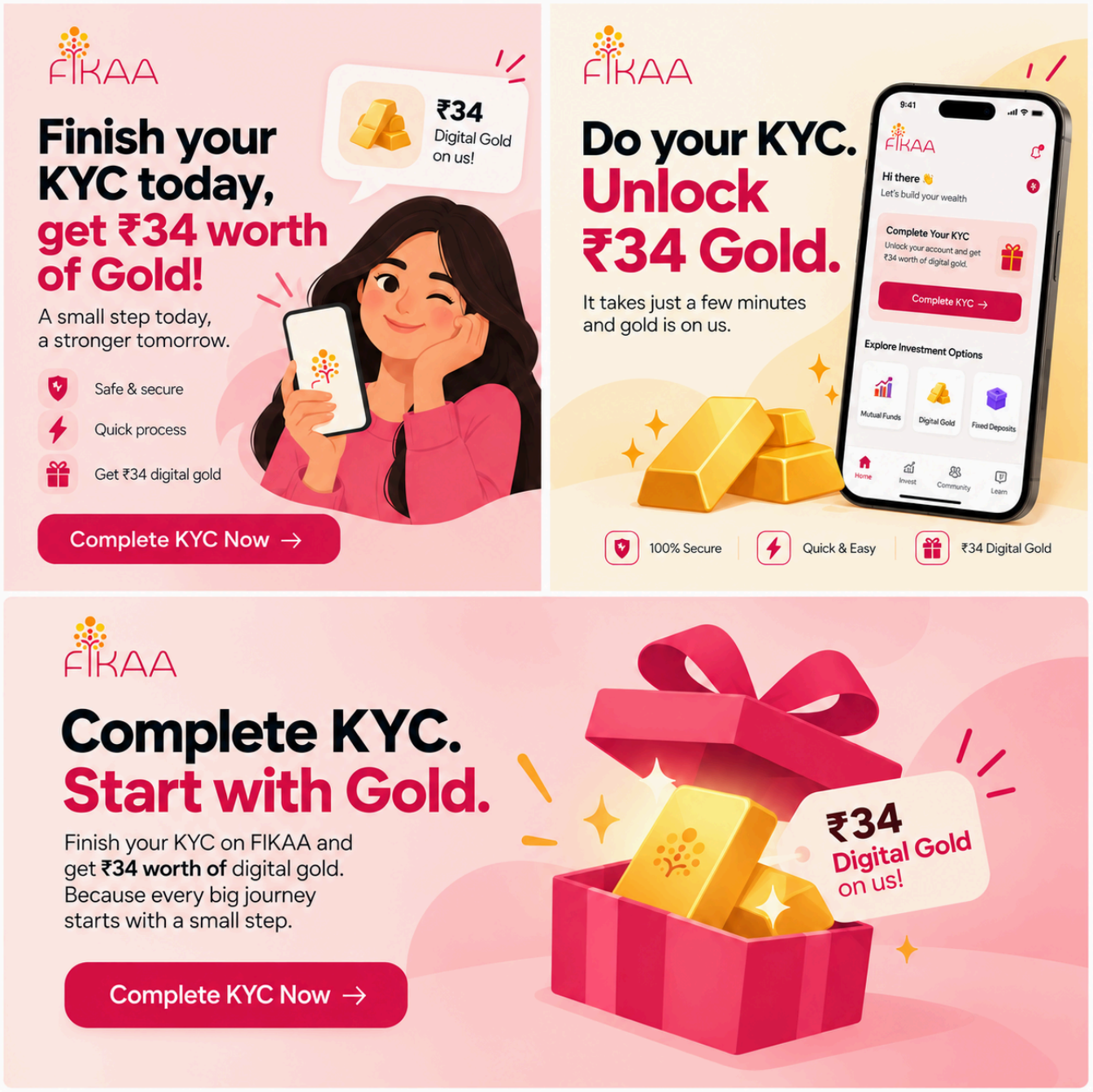
Reward mechanics

I noticed some users were motivated mainly by the incentive, and I raised the idea of stronger qualification, or a less frictionless reward withdrawal. In a future iteration, I'd take this to product, growth and compliance together: can eligibility rules and reward mechanics reduce abuse while staying transparent and fair? What I wouldn't do is make withdrawal deliberately confusing as a substitute for clear terms and proper measurement.

Creative concepts

Three message territories, one clear next step.

The concepts below reconstruct the strategy we discussed. New wording is labelled as an example hook, not verbatim historical copy. The original ad files weren't in the material I had.



AI-generated for visual representation and better understanding.

Tangible reward

Barrier: "What's in it for me?"

> **EXAMPLE HOOK** Complete your KYC and get ₹34 worth of digital gold.
>
> **EXECUTION** Lead with the offer, state the required action and use one clear CTA. The concrete benefit is easy to understand.

Risk and what to test. The reward may become the only motivation. Compare it with the other angles, and measure KYC completion and activation, not just signups.

Investing made approachable

Barrier: "Is this complicated?"

> **EXAMPLE HOOK** New to investing? Start with one clear step.
>
> **EXECUTION** Plain language, a clear sequence and one main point per asset.

Risk and what to test. Educational messaging may win attention without moving people to KYC. Measure KYC start and completion rates.

Trust and financial independence

Barrier: "Can I trust this, and why is it relevant to me?"

> **EXAMPLE HOOK** Take a first step towards understanding your money.
>
> **EXECUTION** Verifiable brand context, connected to the women-first purpose.

Risk and what to test. Purpose-led creative may get fewer clicks but better downstream intent. Compare approved KYC and first-investment rate where tracking permits.

Format adaptations

Format recalled or considered	Creative treatment	Question to measure
Static / square	Reward and CTA in a clear visual hierarchy	Is the offer understood quickly?
Reel / Story	The action shown in a short, accessible sequence	Does the first frame hold attention and lead to meaningful action?
Carousel	One idea per card, ending with the next step	Do users keep swiping and move to KYC?

Format recalled or considered	Creative treatment	Question to measure
Banner-style	Short copy and a clear offer visual	Confirm the actual placement before claiming a specific channel such as Google

Measurement framework

Measure the journey beyond the signup.

The 10,000+ signups tell us we got attention. Without KYC and downstream metrics, though, we can't say anything about conversion quality or efficiency. Here's the funnel I'd want to see, and what we actually have for each step.

Funnel stage	Metric	What it answers	Available evidence
Acquisition	Registrations / signups	Did the campaign generate initial interest?	10,000+ signups reported in about one week
KYC intent	KYC starts ÷ signups	Did registrants start the intended next step?	Unavailable
KYC completion	Completed KYC ÷ KYC starts	Where did users drop off?	Unavailable; KYC recalled as a friction point
KYC approval	Approved KYC ÷ completed submissions	How many passed verification?	Unavailable
Efficiency	Spend ÷ approved KYC	What did a verified user cost?	Budget and approved KYC count unavailable
Activation	First investment ÷ approved KYC	Did verified users move into product use?	Unavailable
User quality	Defined post-KYC activity or first investment	Did users continue beyond the reward?	Qualitative concern only
Retention	Repeat activity within an agreed period	Did activated users stay engaged?	Unavailable

What I'd report next time

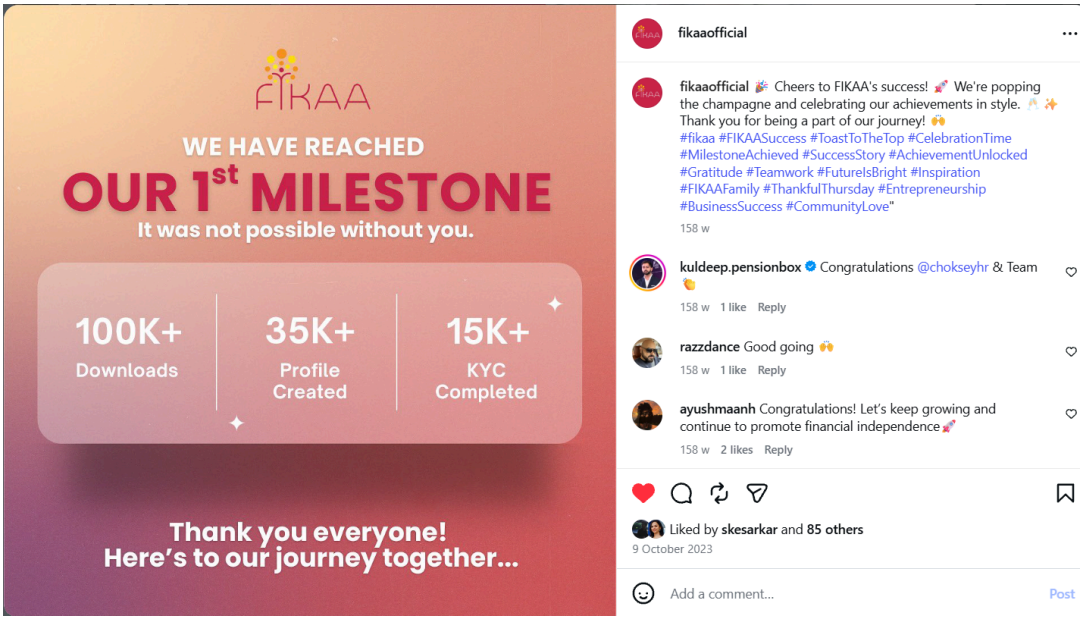
- Results by concept and format, with spend and sample size.
- KYC start, completion and approval rates, and cost per approved KYC, not just cost per signup.
- First-investment rate and post-KYC activity, kept clearly separate from qualitative feedback and hypotheses.

I'd want the growth team to agree the primary conversion event, attribution window, sample size and decision thresholds before launch. Without spend and funnel baselines, I can't responsibly set numerical targets or name a winning creative, and I'd rather be honest about that than pretend.

Failure metrics and learning

What worked, what was a warning sign, and what I still don't know.

This campaign generated a substantial number of reported signups. The limitation is that the evidence I have doesn't show how many users completed KYC, got approved or invested. The fairest verdict I can give: partial success at acquisition, with user quality left unresolved.



Area	What happened, or what we did	My interpretation
Acquisition hook	A ₹34 digital-gold incentive tied to KYC	A clear offer and a reported signup milestone point to substantial initial interest

Creative structure	Three message themes (reward, investing made simple, trust), adapted into multiple formats	A useful strategic structure; no ad-level results show which theme won
Signup result	10,000+ signups in about one week; a team result	A meaningful top-of-funnel result, not proof of 10,000 approved or active investors
KYC friction	KYC recalled as a major drop-off point, because personal-information requests feel sensitive	The journey needed clearer explanation and funnel measurement

Area	What happened, or what we did	My interpretation
Incentive quality	Some users seemed mainly motivated by the reward; exact count or percentage unavailable	A qualitative warning sign, not a quantified failure rate
Audience fit	Men also signed up and completed KYC, despite women-first positioning	Worth reviewing for alignment, without assuming male users are automatically low quality
Downstream results	KYC approval, spend, cost, first investment and retention unavailable	Final efficiency and long-term value can't be quantified

The failure metrics we should have tracked

These aren't invented numbers. They're the funnel steps that needed reporting: KYC completion and approval, cost per approved KYC, first-investment rate, and activity after the reward. That last one matters most. It's the only way to tell whether our signups and KYCs were potential users, or just reward seekers. With those numbers, the team could have diagnosed whether the issue sat mainly with the creative promise, the audience setup, the KYC experience, the reward mechanics, or a mix of all four.

My contribution, and what the team learned

I raised concerns about reward-driven users and suggested stronger qualification. Those ideas were countered well and didn't make the final setup. Looking back, it was a shared growth problem: creative sets expectations, but onboarding, audience strategy, reward rules and measurement shape user quality just as much.

Risks, limitations and final takeaway

What this case study can claim, and what it can't.

Topic	Included	Limit or disclaimer
Signup result	10,000+ signups in about one week	A team outcome; no individual attribution or independent dashboard verification
KYC and user quality	My recollection of KYC friction and reward-seeking behaviour	No verified completion, approval, or incentive-only user count or rate

Topic	Included	Limit or disclaimer
Creative concepts	Reward, approachable investing and trust	Some hooks are reconstructed examples, not verified original copy
Competitive research	Publicly dated FIKAA and LXME context from 2023	Not a complete historical ad audit; no claims about competitor performance
Media placement	Multiple formats discussed	The exact media mix is unconfirmed; no Google placement claimed without records
Financial performance	No invented CPA, ROAS or budget figures	Spend, approved KYC, activation and retention unavailable

Risks and guardrails

- **KYC clarity.** KYC is an important verification step in financial services. Creative should explain it accurately, never imply it's unnecessary.
- **Reward terms.** Eligibility and redemption rules should be transparent and reviewed with product and compliance. No deliberately confusing withdrawals.
- **Audience interpretation.** Gender alone is not a proxy for quality. Evaluate audience alignment and downstream behaviour instead.
- **Financial claims.** No return guarantees or unsupported safety claims; use approved disclosures where required.

Final reflection

The 10,000+ signups were a meaningful team result, and I'm proud of my part. The campaign taught me to turn a business goal into distinct creative territories and carry them across formats. It also taught me what I now bring to every brief: volume is only half of performance. If I ran it again, I'd still test the incentive alongside education-led and women-first messages, but tie every test to KYC completion, approval and first investment from day one.

Everyone loves free gold. The real win is the people who stay after they've spent it.

References

Historical research

- LXME × DSP GULLUCK launch. Investment Guru India, 20 June 2023
- LXME GULLUCK campaign video. YouTube
- LXME's women-centric RuPay Dream Card debuts at GFF 2023. IBS Intelligence, 8 September 2023
- FIKAA appoints Naina as its brand ambassador. PR Newswire, 2 November 2023
- Financial independence through knowledge and action. Business India, 17 November 2023

KYC and investor education

- KYC explainer. SEBI Investor
- Getting Ready to Invest. NISM

Campaign evidence

- FIKAA milestone post. Instagram. Verify the wording before citing it as evidence